YAMEN ABBAS

Senior Backend Developer & Team Lead | PHP · Laravel · MySQL · Linux Server Administration

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Backend Developer and Team Lead with 5+ years of experience building and running production web applications with PHP, Laravel, MySQL, and REST APIs. Currently leads development teams and serves as the sole server administrator at a UK-based company, owning deployment and server reliability for 10+ production projects. Experienced in payment and third-party integrations, authentication, and real-time features. Uses AI tools (Claude, ChatGPT) daily to accelerate research, coding, and code review.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Languages:** PHP, JavaScript, SQL, HTML5, CSS3
- **Backend & Frameworks:** Laravel, MVC Architecture, Laravel Queues, Laravel Reverb (real-time)
- **Frontend:** JavaScript, jQuery, Bootstrap; basic React & Inertia.js
- **Databases:** MySQL, Database Design
- **APIs & Integrations:** REST API Development, Third-Party APIs, Microsoft Graph API, PayPal, Tap
- **Authentication & Security:** OAuth, JWT, Two-Factor Authentication (2FA)
- **Server & Deployment:** Linux (AlmaLinux), VPS Administration, Plesk, DNS, Cron Jobs & Queue Workers, Git-based Deployment, FFmpeg
- **AI-Assisted Development:** Claude, ChatGPT — technical research, code generation & review, debugging, documentation
- **Tools & Version Control:** Git, GitHub, GitLab, Bitbucket, Postman, Jira, Trello

WORK EXPERIENCE

Backend Developer | Team Leader (Remote)

June 2024 – Present

Eco Sourcing Hub Company – United Kingdom

Backend Development

- **Initiated and led development of the Carbon Accounting platform,** starting as the sole developer before building and leading a team to continue its delivery.
- **Designed and developed the core Laravel backend** for the Carbon Accounting platform, including calculation logic, data processing workflows, and Excel-based imports for analyzing company emissions.
- **Audited the legacy Carbon platform's** calculation logic and results to identify weaknesses and set the foundation for the new platform.
- **Designed and built the B2B Portal end-to-end** with PHP, Laravel, and MySQL, and integrated it with the FMCG platform via REST APIs (product data, orders, notifications, dashboards).
- **Built a Video Review & Approval platform single-handedly,** shipping the first version in about 5 days with an AI-assisted workflow (Laravel 12 backend, React 19 + Inertia.js frontend), including real-time chat and comments and FFmpeg video processing; it is in daily production use by management and the design team.

Team Leadership

- **Led a team of 5 on the Response Code mobile app** (Laravel API and admin panel, Flutter app, Next.js web platform): delivered the beta release in September 2026 and now manage post-beta fixes and client feedback.
- **Run daily team follow-ups and write weekly and monthly progress reports** for management: assigning tasks, tracking blockers, organizing testing, and managing delivery across concurrent projects.
- **Defined requirements, workflows, and technical specifications** for new platforms, including the B2B Portal's migration to Next.js.

Server Administration & Deployment

- **Sole server administrator for 10+ company projects:** migrated Laravel applications from shared hosting to a VPS (Plesk on AlmaLinux 9) and manage multiple production, staging, and development environments on it.
- **Own the deployment process for every project,** deploying from GitLab to production, running migrations, and handling rollbacks and deployment issues.

- **Configured DNS for company domains without disrupting Microsoft 365 email,** set up transactional email through the Microsoft Graph API, and configured queue workers and scheduled tasks.
- **Leading a server continuity initiative:** writing deployment and backup-restore documentation in Arabic and English and training a second engineer to reduce single-person dependency.
- **Contributing to a multi-server architecture proposal** (technical and cost options).

Freelance Backend Developer (Remote)
January 2023 – Present

Delivered complete Laravel backends and business applications for independent clients.

- **Hotel Booking & Management Platform —** multi-role system (admins, owners, customers) with availability, booking and cancellation, multilingual support, reviews, reporting, and automated commissions.
- **Real Estate Management System —** building, apartment, sales, and rental management with expense tracking, a customer-facing property website, and PayPal rental payments.
- **Airline Reservation Management System —** flights, reservations, and tickets, with a customer booking website and PayPal payments.
- **Equipment Reservation System (7awi Company, Dubai, UAE) —** single and multiple photography equipment reservations with email notifications to the manager.

Laravel Developer (Remote)
October 2023 – February 2024

Solution Time – Saudi Arabia

- **Developed and maintained features for production web applications** with PHP and Laravel across more than three projects, following existing architecture and business requirements.
- **Implemented Google2FA-based two-factor authentication** to strengthen login security and protect user accounts.
- **Built statistical charts and data visualizations,** and implemented multi-theme interfaces including light and dark modes.

Laravel Developer (Onsite)
October 2021 – October 2023

Start Tech Company (Dubai, UAE) – Syria Branch

- **Developed and maintained backend applications** with PHP and Laravel, designing MySQL database structures to support business workflows.
- **Integrated third-party services and REST APIs,** including PayPal and Tap payment gateways.
- **Implemented secure authentication and authorization** with OAuth and JWT across more than 10 projects.
- **Built real-time communication features,** including email and push notifications and in-app messaging.
- **Tested, debugged, and resolved issues across 5 projects,** working with Git and Jira in a collaborative team.

EDUCATION

Master of Computer and Electronic Systems Engineering
Tartous University – Syria | 2021 – 2024

Bachelor of Computer Systems Engineering
Tartous University – Syria | 2015 – 2020 | Grade: 79.8%

COURSES & CONTINUOUS LEARNING

- **Linux & Git —** self-directed online courses, applied daily in production server administration
- **DevOps fundamentals —** in progress
- **Odoo Development —** in progress

ACHIEVEMENTS & LANGUAGES

- **Smart Garage Project —** Participant, Al-Basil Innovation Exhibition, Damascus, Syria | 2019
- **Languages:** Arabic (Native) · English (Intermediate)